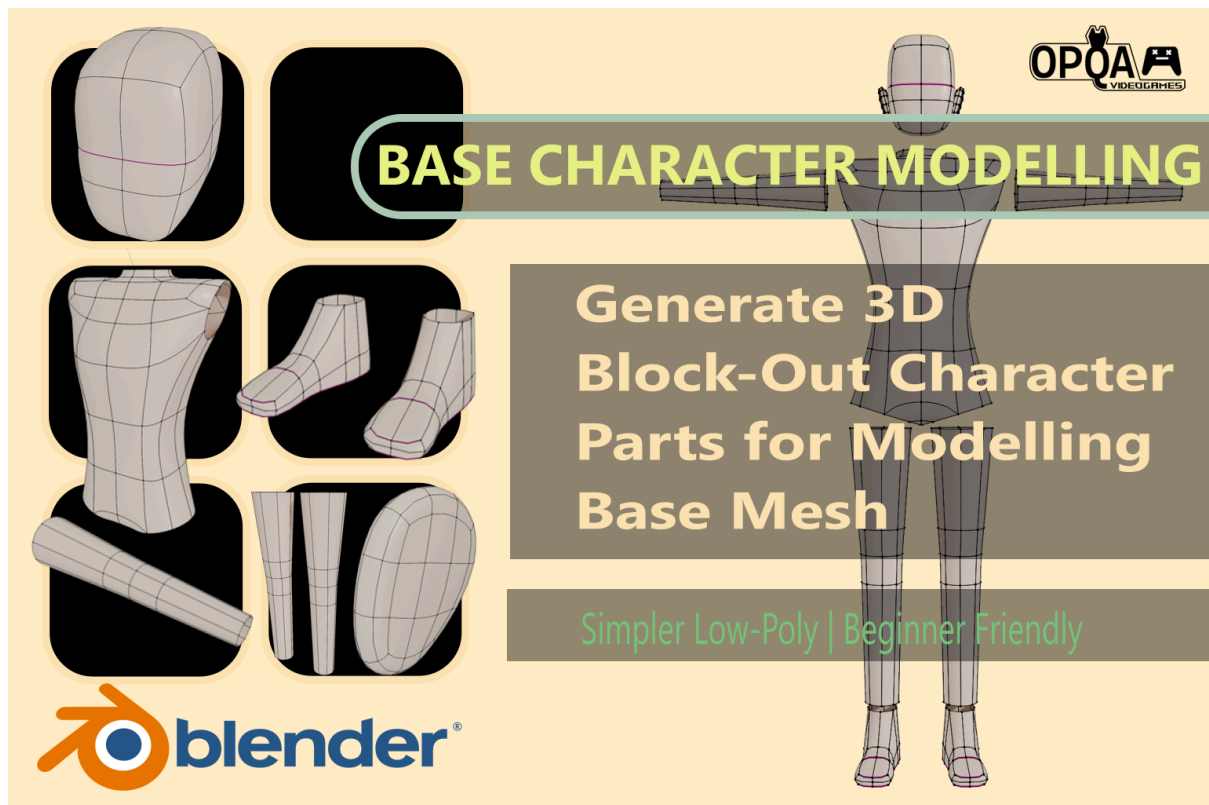


Base Character Modeling (BCM) — User Manual



1) What BCM Does

Base Character Modeling (BCM) is a Blender sidebar add-on for quickly building stylized character bases using references and part templates.

It provides an 8-part build workflow (Head, Ears, Eyes, Torso, Arms, Hands, Legs, Feet), per-part source selection, and guided placement.

2) Where to Find It

Open Blender and go to:

3D Viewport → Sidebar (N) → [Base Character Modeling]

3) Main Features

- 8 body-part tiles with thumbnail previews
- Per-part source selector:
 - User Template
 - BCM Template
- Per-part actions:
 - Save Template
 - Clear
 - Place

- Reference image workflow:
 - Front / Side / Hand Top
 - Mirror toggle (horizontal)
 - Size, position, and opacity controls

4) Quick Start

1. Enable the add-on.
2. Open [Base Character Modeling] in the N-panel.
3. (Optional) Load Front/Side/Hand Top references.
4. For each body part, pick source and use Place.
5. Use Save Template if you want to keep your custom part for reuse.

5) Reference Workflow

- You can load and clear references for Front, Side, and Hand Top.
- Selecting a reference also switches the active view.
- Controls include:
 - Width % / Height %
 - Lock aspect ratio
 - Position controls (axis labels adapt to active view)
 - Opacity toggle + Alpha slider
 - Mirror (horizontal)

6) Template Sources (How BCM Chooses a Model)

Each part uses the selected source mode.

User Template mode priority

1. Scene template
2. Global template (user scripts folder)
3. Shipped BCM template fallback

BCM Template mode priority

1. Shipped BCM template
2. Scene template fallback
3. Global template fallback

Notes:

- If no user template exists for a part, BCM forces BCM Template.
- Source preference is stored per part and restored on load.
- Spawned objects are placed in BCM_Character_Modelling_Base.

7) Build by Parts: Tile Actions

Save Template

Saves selected mesh object(s) as that part's User Template.
Temporary scene cache is auto-cleaned after successful export.

Clear

Removes scene and global template data for that part.

Place

Starts interactive placement for that part based on reference-driven points.

8) Placement Rules

- Most parts use a 2-click placement flow.
- FEET uses a 3-click flow:
 1. Side Ortho point 1
 2. Side Ortho point 2
 3. Front Ortho point 3 (X anchor)

BCM applies per-part axis + scale multipliers internally for more consistent default proportions.

9) Build Full Base

You can run Build Full Base from Blender Operator Search (F3) to generate the full base quickly from available templates.

10) Troubleshooting

“bpy/blf import not resolved” in editor

This is expected in standard Python tooling (outside Blender runtime).
The add-on is intended to run inside Blender.

“Call expression not allowed in type expression” warnings

These are common static-analysis warnings for Blender bpy.props patterns and usually not runtime errors.

Part not spawning as expected

- Verify source mode (User Template vs BCM Template)
- Confirm template exists for that part
- Re-check fallback behavior if custom template is missing

11) Current Limits

- Mirror supports horizontal only.
- Vertical flip (flip_y) is not implemented yet.

12) Versioning Notes

Use your changelog as source of truth for release differences and planned items